



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*dvayoh kṣetrajñayor madhye jīvātmā kṣetra-dharma-bhāk |
badhyate mucyate jñānād ity adhyāyārtha īritah ||
iti sārārtha-varṣiṇyām harṣiṇyām bhakta-cetasām |
trayodaśo 'yaṁ gītāsu saṅgataḥ saṅgataḥ satām ||*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse

1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The essence of this verse distills the wisdom of the Bhagavad Gītā into a potent seed. It speaks of the two knowers of the field, the individual soul (jīvātmā) and the Supreme Soul, residing within the field of activity (kṣetra), which is essentially your body and mind. The jīvātmā, caught in the web of the field's qualities (dharma), experiences bondage and liberation. This liberation, the verse declares, comes through knowledge (jñānāt). The chapter concludes, a wellspring of joy for devotees and a harmonious truth for the virtuous.

Think of your own life as the field. Your thoughts, emotions, actions, and experiences are the qualities of this field. The jīvātmā, your individual consciousness, gets entangled in these qualities. When you identify solely with your ego, your desires, your fears, you become bound by them. You suffer when the field is unpleasant, and you cling to it when it is pleasurable. This is the cycle of suffering that the Gītā seeks to help you transcend.

The key to liberation, however, lies within. It's not about escaping the field of activity, but about understanding it correctly. Knowledge, in this context, is not mere intellectual understanding, but a deep realization of your true nature as distinct from the fluctuating qualities of the field. This realization dawns when you recognize the presence of the Supreme Soul within you, the unchanging witness of all activity. By cultivating self-awareness, by observing your thoughts and emotions without judgment, you begin to detach from the field's qualities.

In modern life, this translates to mindful living. It means being present in your experiences, but not being defined by them. It means recognizing that you are not your job, your relationships, or your possessions. You are the unchanging consciousness that observes these things. Through practices like meditation and self-reflection, you can cultivate this awareness and gradually free yourself from the bondage of your own mind. This is the path to lasting peace and fulfillment, a journey towards realizing your true potential.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Can you identify one area of your life where you are currently entangled in the qualities of the field, and what small step can you take today to cultivate detachment and awareness?